



Sofija Hotomski

Product Manager

With over a decade of experience shaping products in customer-facing roles, I'm a Product Manager who thrives on turning complex technology into intuitive solutions. With my strong technical background and PhD in Computer Science, I bridge strategy and engineering to bring product visions to life. I've spent my career guiding impactful SaaS cloud transformations on a global scale by not just defining requirements, but driving product decisions that create real value for users and businesses. Known for fostering close, collaborative partnerships across engineering, design, marketing and sales teams, I build trust and momentum to deliver measurable outcomes. Working permit: C (Niederlassungsbewilligung)

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Sabbatical

Independent Projects & Personal Development

03/2025 - Present

Achievements/Tasks

- Designed and built hotomski.com, a personal site showcasing conversational AI integration, powered by OpenAI technologies, with vector database optimization for performance and cost-efficiency.
- Integrated Elasticsearch and Kibana for real-time search analytics, observability and insights into user behavior.
- Self-directed learning in GenAI, search tech and data observability.

Global Product Manager

Siemens AG

01/2022 - 06/2025

Zug, Switzerland

Achievements/Tasks

- Spearheaded the digital transformation of Siemens' traditional fire safety management system into a SaaS cloud [solution](#), including web and mobile applications and [APIs](#) for managing fire safety sites, resulting in 35% global adoption.
- Led product presentations and strategic discussions with C-level stakeholders across global markets to position Siemens' cloud-based fire safety solution.
- Increased revenue by 45% through targeted feature delivery, pricing strategies, and customer engagement initiatives.
- Established new collaboration frameworks between UX, technical teams, and customers to ensure delivery of impactful, user-centered solutions.
- Conducted comprehensive competitor analysis and worked with sales, marketing, and UX teams to align product vision with market demands.

Senior Requirements Engineer/Project Lead

ASMIQ AG (Swiss Post)

05/2019 - 07/2021

Zurich, Switzerland

Achievements/Tasks

- Acted as primary interface between technical teams and executive stakeholders, providing roadmap updates, product walkthroughs, and risk briefings.
- Gathered and formalized product requirements through structured interviews and workshops with clients, ensuring alignment with strategic goals.
- Managed a remote team of six developers to deliver CRM and e-commerce platforms tailored for European markets.
- Regularly facilitated product demo sessions and technical overviews for business leaders and internal decision-makers.



WORK EXPERIENCE

Researcher and Teaching Assistant

University of Zurich

04/2015 - 05/2019

Zurich, Switzerland

Achievements/Tasks

- Conducted research in requirements engineering, developing and evaluating a novel AI (NLP-based) approach to align requirements and acceptance tests as they evolve.
- Led collaboration with 15 global companies to gather requirements, validate conceptual solutions, collect feedback, and assess the real-world performance of the web-based application.
- Published six research papers in peer-reviewed international conferences and journals presenting each to large, diverse audiences of experts and practitioners from around the world.
- Designed and organized university courses in Requirements Engineering and Software Engineering, and supervised both individual and team student projects.

SCADA Project Lead

Schneider Electric DMS

02/2012 - 03/2015

Novi Sad, Serbia

Achievements/Tasks

- Served as a customer-facing technical lead, presenting real-time enterprise SCADA/DMS solutions to utilities across the world.
- Traveled internationally to engage with key stakeholders and customers, presenting state-of-the-art solutions, eliciting requirements for customizations, and building strong, trustful relationships.
- Translated high-level business goals into actionable product requirements, collaborating with cross-functional teams to prioritize features and deliver tailored solutions to customers.

Software Engineer

DMS Group (Siemens)

10/2010 - 02/2012

Novi Sad, Serbia

Achievements/Tasks

- Implemented stored procedures, business logic and presentation layer for large-scale SCADA/DMS applications. Technologies used: PL/SQL, SQL, C# .Net, Java, Oracle DBMS.



EDUCATION

PhD in Computer Science

University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland

04/2015 - 03/2019

Grade: summa cum laude

MSc in Electrical and Computer Engineering

Faculty of Technical Sciences, University of Novi Sad, Serbia

10/2010 - 12/2011

Grade average: 10/10

BSc in Electrical and Computer Engineering

Faculty of Technical Sciences, University of Novi Sad, Serbia

10/2006 - 09/2010

Grade average: 8.4/10



LANGUAGES

Serbian
Native or Bilingual Proficiency

English
Full Professional Proficiency

German
Professional Working Proficiency